

which regularly updates NG data. Google has its own version of newsgroups called Google Groups, which should not be confused with the original NNTP newsgroups. And given Google's never-ending and ever increasing hunger to store and process data, one can be fairly certain that the posts will be there for a long time to come, even after the original NNTP servers have purged them.

Given the similarity between e-mail and newsgroup clients, most e-mail clients can also work as NG readers (and vice versa!), and include the necessary options to configure an NG account. Though, they will lack some of the features present in applications positioned primarily as NG readers.

Configuring an NG client is similar to configuring an e-mail client, but much simpler. One only needs a newsgroup IP to begin with. If the NG only allows registered users, a username and password will also be needed. A list of free NNTP servers can be obtained from online sites like http://www.dmoz.org/Computers/Usenet/Public_News_Servers/

7.1.2 Terminology

Cross Posting: This refers to the practice of posting the same message to different newsgroups.

Binaries: These refer to the non text part of a message—usually pictures, video files, audio files— that are attached with the message. alt.binaries is an NG that is dedicated to posting messages with binary content.

Retention Time: NNTP servers do not store topics indefinitely. The duration for which they retain the topics is the retention time. This varies from server to server.

Multi-part Message: This applies to messages with large attachments. Since servers have limits on the file attachment sizes, users split the attachment over more than one message. These messages constitute a multi-part message. Newsreaders that support multi-part messages are capable of identifying the different parts of a message and joining the attachment to recreate the complete file.

Message Encoding: This is a issue that is applicable more to binary messages. Since NNTP servers were designed to handle text data, to be able to pass binary data through them the message has